★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Harry High-Stakes

Owner of the Deadwood Cantina & host of the big poker tournament party.

How to Play It

Play the smooth, confident host. Glad-hand everybody and keep folks buying sarsaparilla. Whatever happens, never let anyone see you sweat about money.

Starter Lines

❶ Welcome, friends, to the finest soda cantina west of the Mississippi! Root beer's flowin' — spend freely, partner!

❷ Sell my cantina? I'd do just about ANYTHING before I'd see it in somebody else's hands!

❸ That debt of yours? Don't you fret — I'll have every penny by the end of the night. You have my word.

Be Ready If Asked

“Would you sell this cantina? Name your price.” → "Not for all the gold in the Black Hills! This cantina stays in my hands."

“When are you paying what you owe?” → "By the end of the night, guaranteed. Root beer on the house!"

“Is the cantina going to close?” → "Never! I've got a plan to keep these doors open and under MY management."

When to use these: Right after you read the welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Henrietta High-Stakes

Harry's business partner and co-owner of the Deadwood Cantina.

How to Play It

You're the grand hostess and the center of attention. Show off your fancy necklace, keep the staff in line, and look down your nose at the bankers.

Starter Lines

❶ Billie, you'd best find a way to make those books balance, or you'll be one sorry barmaid!

❷ Why, thank you! Harry bought me this necklace. Isn't it just the prettiest thing in Deadwood?

❸ Banker Bob, how do you feel about Bonnie spendin' so much time in MY cantina lately?

Be Ready If Asked

“Where'd you get that fancy necklace?” → Smile sweetly: "Why, Harry bought it for me."

“Are you stealing from the cantina?” → Deny it! "How DARE you! Mind your own business."

“Will you let the bank take the cantina?” → "Over my dead body. This cantina stays with Harry and me."

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Gambling Jack

Famous card shark — undefeated for five years... until this week.

How to Play It

Show-off with a sore spot. Stay gracious about your loss, stick close to your backer Anna Belle, and act like a champion on his best behavior.

Starter Lines

① Anna Belle, I couldn't have come this far without your backin'. You're my lucky charm, partner.

② Holly, Mitch, Clay — that was one fine tournament. Tip of the hat to every one of you.

Billie, between you and me… can that Poker Alice be trusted with a deck of cards? 3

Be Ready If Asked

“How do you stay undefeated? I've been watching your hands...” → Laugh it off: pure skill, friend. If they keep pressing, slip them a few Deadwood dollars to drop it.

“How do you know Harry so well?” → "We go way back at the card tables. Old friends, that's all."

“Was there cheating in the tournament?” → "The cards just didn't fall my way. Ask the fellas who won."

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Anna Belle

Gambling Jack's wealthy backer and longtime friend — his 'good luck charm' from the South.

How to Play It

A proud Southern lady who's above all these Westerners. Insist loudly that Jack was cheated, and keep a sharp eye on every card player in the room.

Starter Lines

① There's no way Jack lost fair and square. Somebody at that table cheated him, and I aim to find out who!

② Holly Hickok, you sweet-talkin' sidewinder — I saw you cozyin' up to Jack this week!

③ Harry, how exactly do you know Jack so well? You two seem awful chummy.

Be Ready If Asked

“How do you feel about Jack's loss?” → "Robbed! Jack was cheated, plain as day."

“Who do you think cheated?” → "Holly Hickok, that sidewinder! I'll prove it before the night is through."

“You've got the wrong card player, honey.” → "Then who is it? Tell me this instant!"

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Mitch Maverick

Traveling businessman from the East and surprise winner of the tournament.

How to Play It

Friendly, chatty, and humble about your big win — act just as surprised as everyone else. Keep a low profile and charm your way out of hard questions.

Starter Lines

❶ Name's Mitch Maverick, friend. Not 'hey you,' not anything else — Mitch Maverick.

❷ Oh, I'm no card player — I'm a businessman from back East. Travel in the same circles as Mr. Montgomery Money.

❸ Cheating? Partner, you've got no proof of that — beginner's luck, plain and simple!

Be Ready If Asked

“Congratulations! Going to play cards for a living now?” → Act humble: "Shucks, I'm just a businessman. Beginner's luck!"

“You cheated to win!” → "You've got no proof of that, partner. None at all."

“Are you and Minnie still close?” → "Minnie made her decision, and I'm more than happy with it."

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Holly Hickok

A Southern belle with a flair for poker, wowing the West.

How to Play It

Outgoing, spontaneous and charming, with a thick Southern drawl. Sweet-talk your way into getting what you want.

Starter Lines

❶ Why, Mitch, sugar, you know I just LET you win. Surely a little of that purse belongs to me?

❷ Cheat? Me? Heavens no! It's against my morals, darlin'.

❸ Call me a sidewinder, will ya? Well, you're nothin' but a low-down polecat!

Be Ready If Asked

“You're a sidewinder!” → Fire right back: "Well, you're nothin' but a low-down polecat!"

“Did you cheat in the tournament?” → "Cheat? Me? Never! It's against my morals, darlin'."

“Where are you from? I can't place your accent.” → "Why, down South, sugar. Where else?" Then change the subject.

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Clay Coldwell

Local card player and Deadwood regular — once a poker great, now down on his luck.

How to Play It

A cowboy at heart and a regular at the cantina. Act hurt that Sally's been ignoring you, and turn your attention to the newcomer, Minnie.

Starter Lines

❶ Sally Starr, I'm done payin' for your attention. A fella's got his pride.

❷ Miss Minnie Money! What brings a fine Eastern lady to a dusty town like Deadwood?

❸ Banker Bob, any truth to the rumor your bank's fixin' to take over this cantina?

Be Ready If Asked

“Why aren't you paying any attention to Sally Starr?” → "Ask Sally! She's the one who chose money over me."

“How close are you and Mitch Maverick, really?” → "Met him this week. Friendly fella to share a card table with."

“You can only dance with me if you buy a ticket.” → "Then I'll find a partner who doesn't charge. Evenin', Miss Minnie!"

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Montgomery Money

Land investor from Chicago, arrived just last night with his eye on the cantina.

How to Play It

A dignified Eastern businessman who trusts no one. You're obsessed with time — wear your watch on your RIGHT wrist and check it often.

Starter Lines

❶ Harry, this is a mighty fine cantina. I'd pay you a good price for it — think it over.

❷ My business trip? Quite productive, thank you. Sorry I was delayed in St. Louis.

❸ Sheriff, any leads on that bank robbery? There sure are an awful lot of outlaws in this town.

Be Ready If Asked

“How was your business trip? Why so late getting here?” → "Quite productive, thank you. Sorry I got delayed in St. Louis."

“What brings you to Deadwood?” → "Investing. Land, and maybe this very cantina."

“I'll keep you from buying this cantina!” → Check your watch, unbothered: "We'll see, son. Money talks."

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Elizabeth Money

Montgomery's sister and Minnie's aunt, visiting from the East — not fond of the West.

How to Play It

Refined, educated and appalled by this rough town. Fuss over your niece Minnie and keep her away from 'hooligan men of the West.'

Starter Lines

❶ Minnie, dear, you stay away from these hooligans. The West is no place for a proper young lady!

❷ Mr. Maverick, it would be in your best interest to stay far away from my family.

❸ Mr. Jesse Wales, what exactly brings an outlaw like you to town this week?

Be Ready If Asked

“How do you like the West? Have you felt safe?” → "Not one bit! Outlaws roam free and the sheriff does nothing."

“Are you planning on living out here?” → "Heavens, no! I can't leave this dusty town soon enough."

“I'd be a better friend for Minnie than Mitch!” → "I'll be the judge of that. Minnie stays away from you hooligans."

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Minnie Money

Montgomery's daughter — a sheltered debutante on her first trip out West.

How to Play It

A free spirit who loves attention and controversy. You'll do as you please, no matter who it upsets — and you're not charging for dance tickets!

Starter Lines

Stealing your dance-ticket customers? I'll do as I please, thank you very much! 1

❷ Mitch Maverick, I'm done with you — and you'll pay for the way you snubbed me!

❸ Sally Starr, folks out West like Clay prefer MY company over yours.

Be Ready If Asked

“Stop stealing our dance-ticket customers!” → "I'll do as I please, thank you very much!"

“How do you feel about Holly Hickok?” → "She's my least favorite person at this whole party!"

“Are you and Mitch still close?” → "We're through! And he's going to pay for snubbing me."

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Banker Bob

Owner of the Bank of Deadwood — and the bank was robbed earlier this week!

How to Play It

Business first, last and always. Hunt for the bank robber yourself — you don't trust lazy Sheriff Sam to do it.

Starter Lines

❶ Harry, I need what you owe the bank by tomorrow, or the bank takes this cantina.

❷ Where were you at the noon hour earlier this week, when my bank was held up?

❸ Mr. Money, I may have a business proposition for you... depending on how tonight turns out.

Be Ready If Asked

“How do you feel about Bonnie spending so much time in the cantina?” → "She can do as she pleases!" (But look secretly worried.)

“Is the bank going to take over the cantina?” → "If Harry doesn't make enough money tonight, I may have to foreclose."

“I've got a tip on who robbed your bank!” → Get suspicious: "Who told you that? And what's in it for you?"

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Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

✂ -

★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Banker Bonnie

Banker Bob's business partner at the Bank of Deadwood.

How to Play It

A little snooty and fond of your money. Act confident and nosy, and make it clear Bob pays more attention to his vault than to you.

Starter Lines

❶ Barb Cassidy! What on earth are you STILL doing here in town?

❷ Henrietta, if Harry loses this cantina, it goes to the bank, sugar — not to you.

❸ Bob, if you cared about me half as much as that bank of yours, you'd be a richer man!

Be Ready If Asked

“Why are you in the cantina so much lately?” → "Simply checking up on my investments, dear."

“Why aren't you spending more time with Bob?” → "Ask Bob. He spends all his time with that vault!"

“So glad you weren't hurt in the bank hold-up!” → "Why, thank you. It was terrifying! Bob only cares about his money, though."

> **When to use these:** After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Jesse Wales

Outlaw. Here to meet up with old acquaintances... or strictly on business?

How to Play It

Rough, rugged and a little scary. You don't say much — let your stare do the talking. Keep your LEFT hand bandaged all night.

Starter Lines

① Why am I in town? Here to collect on an old debt, that's all.

Billie, a word of advice: that Poker Alice can be dangerous. Watch yourself. 2

③ Barb Cassidy, fancy meetin' you here. What brings you to Deadwood?

Be Ready If Asked

“Why are you in town?” → "Collecting on an old debt. That's all you need to know."

“What happened to your hand?” → Stare them down: "Little disagreement. Don't ask again."

“Did you rob the bank? When are you leaving?” → "Wasn't me. I'm gone the minute my debt is settled."

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Poker Alice

The cantina's poker dealer — loyal to her favorite barmaid, Billie.

How to Play It

A real woman of the West. Watch everyone like you're dealing cards, keep your feelings close to the vest, and fish for information.

Starter Lines

① Henrietta, what a lovely necklace! Now how'd you afford that, with the cantina in such a pickle?

② Jesse Wales, what happened to that hand of yours? And just why are you in town?

Anna Belle, you're barkin' up the wrong tree — you've got the wrong card player, honey. 3

Be Ready If Asked

“Why did you let so much cheating go on in the tournament?” → "I deal the cards, I don't read minds. Bring me proof."

“Someone saw you coming out of the bank during the robbery!” → "Whoever said that has an axe to grind. Consider the source."

“What's the deal with you and Billie?” → "Billie's my dearest friend in Deadwood, and that's all you need to know."

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Sheriff Sam

The Deadwood sheriff — word is the only way to get anything 'enforced' is to pad Sam's wallet.

How to Play It

Act like you're in charge, even when you're not — the Marshal's watching you. Swagger, bluster, and chase every lead on the bank robbery.

Starter Lines

❶ I'm still investigatin' that bank robbery, and I'll crack it before the night's through!

❷ Outlaws in my town pay a little 'visitor fee.' Pay up, pardner.

❸ Jesse Wales, just when are you plannin' on leavin' town?

Be Ready If Asked

“Any leads on the bank robbery?” → "Still investigatin'! I'll crack it, don't you worry."

“Just what 'duties' does the sheriff get paid for?” → "Keepin' the peace, ma'am. And peace ain't cheap."

“I've got a lead on the robber!” → Follow it! "Spill it, and I'll look into it right now."

> **When to use these:** After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

✂ -

★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Marshal Dalton

U.S. Federal Marshal, sent to keep order at the tournament.

How to Play It

Diplomatic but authoritative — you mean business. Keep an eye on Sheriff Sam, and if anything goes wrong tonight, be ready to take charge.

Starter Lines

❶ Sheriff, how's that bank robbery investigation comin' along? Any progress at all?

❷ Taffy, have you seen anything suspicious around this cantina lately?

❸ Miss Elizabeth, have you felt safe here in Deadwood? And if not... why not?

Be Ready If Asked

“Why's a U.S. Marshal in Deadwood?” → "To keep this tournament lawful and see the prize goes to the right person."

“Is Sheriff Sam in trouble?” → "I'm watching everyone in this town. The sheriff included."

“I know something about somebody in this room...” → "Then tell me everything. I'll decide what it's worth."

> **When to use these:** After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Sally Starr

Dancer and server at the cantina, fiercely loyal to Harry and Henrietta.

How to Play It

Sell dance tickets and sarsaparillas to earn money for the cantina. Loyal to your 'cantina family,' but heartbroken that you've had to keep away from your good friend Clay.

Starter Lines

Care for a dance ticket, partner? Just a nickel — it's all for the good of the cantina! 1

❷ Minnie Money, you're cuttin' into my territory takin' my dance-ticket customers. Back off, or you'll be sorry!

❸ I'd do ANYTHING for Harry and Henrietta. They're my cantina family.

Be Ready If Asked

"How devoted are you to Harry and Henrietta?" → "I'd do ANYTHING for them. They're my cantina family."

"What secrets do you know?" → "Secrets cost extra, sugar. How much have you got?"

"Were you only being nice to Clay for his money?" → "No! I have to do something before I lose Clay's friendship forever."

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Taffy Garrette

Dancer and server — the eyes and ears of the cantina who might know a little too much.

How to Play It

The cantina's gossip queen. Ask nosy questions, spread rumors, and be the center of attention all night long.

Starter Lines

❶ Harry, honey, how much longer is this cantina gonna stay open?

❷ Clay Coldwell, you march right back and give your attention to Sally Starr!

Minnie Money, you two-bit sidewinder — stay away from my regular dance-ticket customers! 3

Be Ready If Asked

"Seen anything suspicious around the cantina?" → "Plenty! Bonnie's here all hours and Harry's jumpy as a cat."

"Why's the cantina in money trouble?" → "Ask Billie, she keeps the books. But I've got my suspicions..."

"Why do you care who Clay dances with?" → "Sally's my best friend, and Clay belongs at her side!"

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Barb Cassidy

Outlaw. Barb's been in town all week and no one knows quite why.

How to Play It

A tough bandit with a feminine flair (red lipstick!). Act mysterious about why you're in town, and don't hide that you can't stand Poker Alice.

Starter Lines

❶ Why am I in Deadwood? Business, sugar. Who with? That'll cost ya.

❷ Billie, you sure do pour a fine sarsaparilla. Care to take a stroll with me and swap stories sometime?

❸ Poker Alice? She acts a whole lot more righteous than she really is!

Be Ready If Asked

“What are you doing in town?” → "Business. Pay me and I'll tell you WHO it was with, but never WHAT."

“Who do you think robbed the bank?” → "I saw Poker Alice coming out of that bank during the robbery!"

“Sorry, I'm not interested in 'dangerous company.'” → "Dangerous? Me? Sugar, I'm sweet as sarsaparilla."

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★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Billie-The-Bartender

Barmaid and bookkeeper, with her own suspicions about the cantina's money troubles.

How to Play It Suave and debonair — compliment every customer, it earns better tips! Don't forget your apron and a Western barmaid look (no mustache).

Starter Lines

❶ Harry, there just isn't enough in the account to pay the bank this week.

❷ Mr. Money, I'll tell you straight — I plan to keep you from buyin' this cantina!

❸ Poker Alice? I'd do just about anything for that lady.

Be Ready If Asked

“How are the cantina's finances? Who do you blame?” → "Someone's stealing from within. For a price, I'll tell you who I suspect."

“Watch out, Poker Alice can be dangerous.” → "I'd do anything for that lady. Don't say a word against her."

“Billie, care to take a stroll with me?” → Let them down easy: "Sorry, I'm not interested in 'dangerous company.'"

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Conversation starters for the opening of the party • your character sheet always comes first

★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Deadwood Townsfolk

Dancer, Card player, Patron or Traveler — one of the colorful crowd at the tournament party.

How to Play It

Mingle, gossip and stir the pot! Pick a Western name, ask everybody nosy questions, and pass along any juicy rumors you hear. Dancers: sell those dance tickets and sarsaparillas!

For any extra role: pick 3 to use

① Mitch Maverick! Congratulations on the big win — a businessman beat the poker greats? How'd you do it?
② Harry, should we be worried about this cantina closin' its doors?
③ Sheriff Sam, got any leads on who robbed the bank earlier this week?
④ Henrietta, that's a mighty fancy necklace. Where'd you get it?
⑤ Billie, just how bad are the cantina's finances, and who do you blame?
⑥ Jesse Wales, what brings you to town — and what happened to that hand?

Be Ready If Asked

“Why are you in town?” → Make up a story: passing through to the gold fields, here for the tournament, visiting kin...

“Did you see anything this week?” → "Didn't see the robbery myself, but I've heard plenty of talk. What have YOU heard?"

“Who do you suspect?” → "I've got my eye on a few folks. Buy me a sarsaparilla and I'll tell ya." (Share gossip; don't invent evidence.)

> **When to use these:** After Harry's welcome, pick 3 lines, go find the person each one mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

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